Bid It Right — Feature Spec

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Overview

Bid It Right is a standalone team auction game website, separate from Verilo Learn. Teachers sign up and play in any browser, with no app to install. It works for online classes, where students join on their own devices with a code, and for offline classrooms, where one projected screen is enough. It is free to play, and a Pro tier unlocks AI-generated sets, analytics and bigger classes.

- **Who it's for:** teachers of teens and adults, in person or online, on any platform (Zoom, Meet, Teams, or a classroom projector). Language teachers are the launch audience, but any subject works, because a "statement" can be a sentence, a maths answer, a history fact or a vocabulary definition.
- **Why it's different:** Kahoot, Baamboozle and Wordwall reward speed or luck. Bid It Right rewards judgement and risk, and every wrong answer becomes a speaking moment.
- **Business goal:** its own subscription revenue, sold directly to teachers like Baamboozle and Kahoot. The AI set generator and per-student error reports are the main upgrade drivers.

Success measures for the first 90 days

- Share of active teachers who host at least one game
- Free-to-Pro conversion among teachers who hit the 3-saved-games limit
- Games hosted per teacher per month

Gameplay and rules

A game is one set of 8 to 15 statements played in rounds, and the richest team at the end wins.

1. **Setup.** The teacher picks a set and splits students into 2 to 4 teams (up to 10 on Pro). Each team starts with 1,000 coins.
2. **Reveal.** One statement appears on everyone's screen. A countdown runs (default 30 seconds, teacher can change it).
3. **Secret bid.** Each team's captain enters a bid from 0 up to the team's balance. Teammates can see and suggest the bid on their own screens. Bids stay hidden until the timer ends.

4. **Lock and reveal.** The teacher taps Reveal. All bids show at once, then the statement is marked correct or incorrect.
5. **Scoring.**
   - Correct statement: every team that bid wins its bid back plus the same amount again.
   - Incorrect statement: every team that bid loses its bid.
   - Bid of 0: no change.
6. **Fix-it bonus.** After an incorrect statement, any team that lost money can try to fix it. The teacher picks a team, a student says or types the correction, and the teacher taps Accept or Reject. Accept returns half of that team's lost bid.
7. **Next round** until the set ends. A final leaderboard shows balances and a short recap of every statement with its correction.

Rules and edge cases

- A team at 0 coins gets a 100-coin "bailout" once per game, so nobody sits out.
- If a captain doesn't bid before time runs out, the bid counts as 0.
- The teacher can pause, skip a statement, or adjust any team's balance by hand.
- Optional "double round" setting: the last statement pays and costs double.

Play modes

The teacher picks a mode in the lobby; the rules and scoring are the same in both.

Mode	Best for	How teams bid
Join with devices	Online classes, or in-person rooms where students have phones	Students open the website on any device and enter a 6-digit game code. The captain bids on their phone; teammates suggest.
One screen, no devices	Offline classrooms with a projector or TV	Only the teacher's screen is used. Teams write their bid on a mini whiteboard or paper and hold it up together; the teacher taps each team tile and types the bid.

- In one-screen mode the teacher's screen hides typed bids until Reveal, so the whole class still sees them appear at once.
- The fix-it bonus works the same way: a student says the correction out loud and the teacher taps Accept or Reject.

- Students never need an account. Only the teacher signs up.

Roles and screens

The website has a teacher side (signed in) and a student side (no account, joined by code). The teacher's host screen is designed to be projected in a classroom or screen-shared in a video call.

Screen	Role	What it does
Landing page and sign-up	Visitor	Explains the game, shows plans, lets a teacher sign up free.
Game library	Teacher	Lists saved sets, premade sets and the AI generator button. Shows the free-tier counter ("2 of 3 saved games").
Set editor	Teacher	Add, edit and reorder statements. Each has text, correct or incorrect, the correction, and an optional explanation.
Lobby	Teacher	Choose play mode, show the game code, set up teams (auto or drag), set timer, start game.
Host screen	Teacher (projected)	Big statement, team tiles with bid status, timer, Reveal, Accept/Reject fix, Pause, Skip, Adjust coins. In one-screen mode, tapping a team tile opens a bid entry pad.
Join	Student	Enter the game code and a nickname, then pick or get a team.
Phone bid screen	Student	Statement, team balance, bid buttons (0, 100, 250, All in) and slider, countdown. Captain locks in; others suggest.
Reveal and fix-it	Everyone	All bids revealed together, correct/incorrect stamp, coin changes animated, the correction highlighted.
Final leaderboard	Everyone	Ranked balances, winning team, recap of every statement and correction.
Error report (Pro)	Teacher	Per student and per class: error types they bid on most, accuracy over time, export.

The host screen's text must be readable from the back of a classroom: statements at least 48px on a 1280px-wide screen, team names and balances at least 24px.

Free vs Pro

Free must be good enough to play in a real class every week; Pro sells saved time and insight, not the game itself.

Feature	Free	Pro
Host live games	Unlimited	Unlimited
Play modes (devices or one screen)	Both	Both
Saved custom sets	3	Unlimited
Teams per game	Up to 4	Up to 10
Premade set library	Starter sets	Full library
AI set generator	2 tries to sample it	Unlimited (fair-use cap)
Homework / solo mode	No	Yes
Per-student error reports	Class score only	Full reports + export
Themes	Default	All themes + own logo
Export set to PDF worksheet	No	Yes

Add-on packs (one-off purchase): themed premade sets such as IELTS, business English, maths facts, science myths. Available to both tiers.

Pricing: amounts to be decided. Pro is a monthly or yearly subscription for individual teachers, with a school licence (several teachers, one bill) added later.

Paywall moments (show the upgrade prompt only here, never mid-game):

- Saving a 4th set
- Adding a 5th team in the lobby
- After the 2nd free AI generation
- Opening a student's error report
- Final leaderboard: a small "See what each student got wrong" teaser

AI set generator

The teacher describes a set in a few fields and gets an editable draft in under 15 seconds.

Inputs

- Subject (English grammar, vocabulary, maths, science, history, other)
- Level (CEFR A1–C1 for English; grade or "beginner / intermediate / advanced" for others)
- Topic or target point, free text ("present perfect vs past simple, travel")
- Number of statements (8–15) and share that are incorrect (default about 50%)
- Optional: a list of common errors to include ("missing articles", "wrong plural")

Output per statement: text, correct or incorrect, the corrected version, a one-line explanation, and an error-type tag (for example "tense", "article", "agreement", "fact"). Error tags feed the Pro error reports.

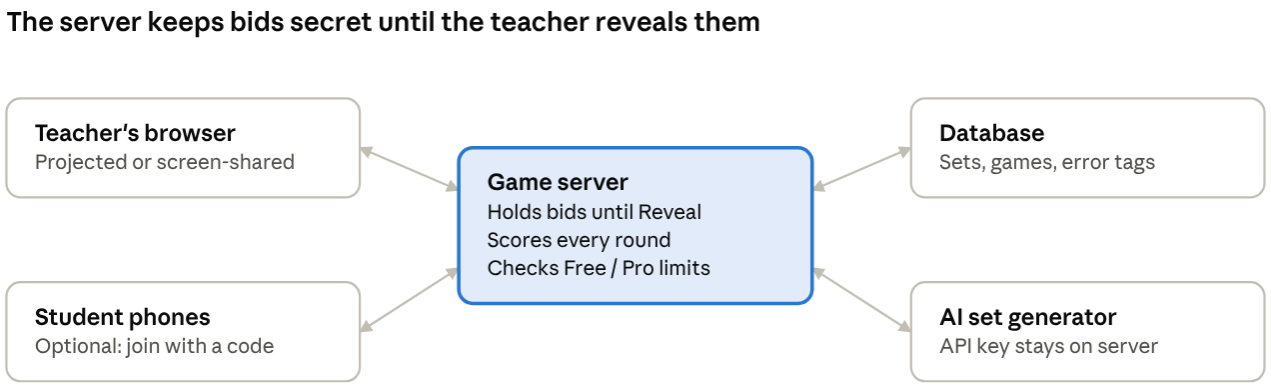
Rules for the model prompt

- Only one error per incorrect statement, so the fix is clear.
- Errors must be plausible learner mistakes, not random typos.
- Vocabulary and length must fit the chosen level.
- No repeated statements within a set.

Implementation: call the AI from the server, never from the browser, so the API key stays hidden. Return JSON in a fixed schema and validate it before showing the draft. The teacher always reviews and can edit before saving.

Architecture and data model

The game server is the single source of truth: it stores every bid privately and only broadcasts them after the teacher taps Reveal.



Bid It Right architecture · clients, game server, database, AI

Bid It Right is a web app with its own domain, accounts and billing, fully separate from Verilo Learn. Every browser in a game connects to the server over one realtime channel per game (WebSocket). In one-screen mode only the teacher's browser connects.

- Scoring, bailouts and Free/Pro limits run on the server, never in the client, so they can't be tampered with.
- A student's screen never receives another team's bid before Reveal.
- Game state is saved after every round so a dropped connection can rejoin cleanly.

Table	Key fields
teachers	id, email, name, plan (free or pro), billing_customer_id, ai_generations_used
sets	id, owner_id, title, subject, level, is_premade, pack_id
statements	id, set_id, position, text, is_correct, correction, explanation, error_tag
games	id, set_id, host_id, join_code, mode (devices or one_screen), status, settings (timer, double round), started_at, ended_at
teams	id, game_id, name, balance, bailout_used, captain_player_id
players	id, game_id, team_id, nickname, joined_at (students, no account)
bids	id, game_id, statement_id, team_id, amount, entered_by (captain or teacher), submitted_at
fixes	id, game_id, statement_id, team_id, player_id, text, accepted
purchases	teacher_id, pack_id, purchased_at

Build phases for Claude Code

Build in four phases, each shippable on its own; hand Claude Code one phase at a time with this doc attached.

1. **Phase 1 — Playable core (free tier).** Standalone website with teacher sign-up, set editor, lobby, host screen, join by code, phone bid screen, one-screen mode, reveal, fix-it, final leaderboard, 3 premade sets.

- [ ] A teacher can sign up, create a set of 8 statements and save it
- [ ] 4 teams on separate phones can join with a code and bid; bids stay hidden until Reveal
- [ ] In one-screen mode the teacher can enter all 4 bids on one screen and reveal them together
- [ ] Scoring, fix-it bonus and bailout match the rules section exactly
- [ ] A student who reconnects mid-game rejoins their team with the right balance
- [ ] The host screen is readable when projected at 1280px wide

2. **Phase 2 — Limits, billing and paywall.** Free-tier counters, upgrade prompts at the paywall moments, Pro subscription checkout.
   - [ ] Saving a 4th set on free shows the upgrade prompt and does not save
   - [ ] No upgrade prompt ever appears during a running game
   - [ ] A paid checkout switches the teacher to Pro straight away
3. **Phase 3 — AI generator.** Server endpoint, input form, draft review screen, error tags.
   - [ ] 20 test generations across 4 subjects all return valid JSON
   - [ ] Every incorrect statement has exactly one error and a correction
4. **Phase 4 — Pro extras.** Error reports, homework mode, themes, PDF export, add-on pack store.
   - [ ] Error report shows each student's top 3 error types after one game
   - [ ] Homework link lets a student play a set solo and the result appears in the report